

The Day the Tablet Slept

A PLAY BEFORE PIXELS READ-ALoud



The Day the Tablet Slept

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The illustrations are flat digital art. The text is set in Fredoka, with Bricolage Grotesque and Nunito Sans.

A note for grown-ups: puddle play, cooking and box-building are best enjoyed with a grown-up close by. The tablet in this story is a made-up character and is not based on any real product.

Free Play Day planner for grown-ups to print:
playbeforepixels.com/bonus/picture-tablet-slept

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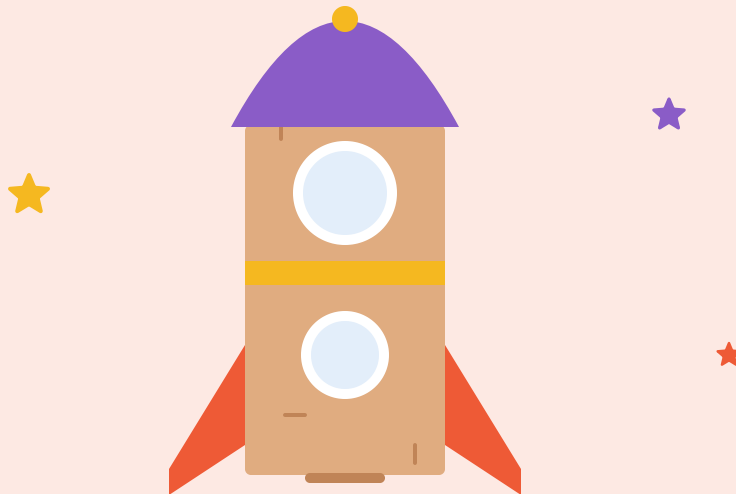


FOUNDER WRITES THIS PAGE

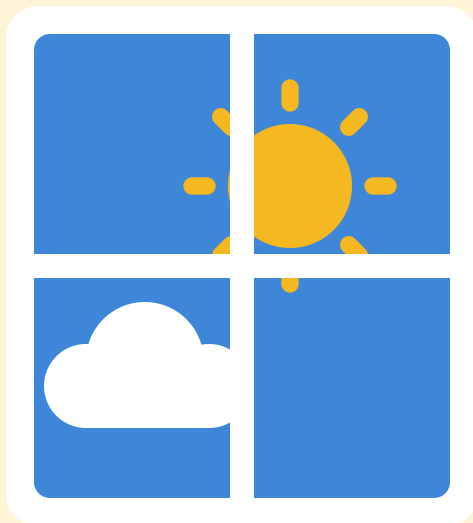
Your dedication, in your own words.

Type it under *## dedication* in WORDS.md, then rebuild.

This box disappears once you do.



On Saturday morning,
Ada zoomed downstairs.
Her slippers were on
the wrong feet.
She didn't care one bit.



But the tablet was wearing a nightcap.
Its eyes were shut tight.
And it was going...

zzz-bip... zzz-bip...



“Shhh,” whispered Papa.
“The tablet is sleeping.
It worked hard all week.
Today, it gets a day off.”

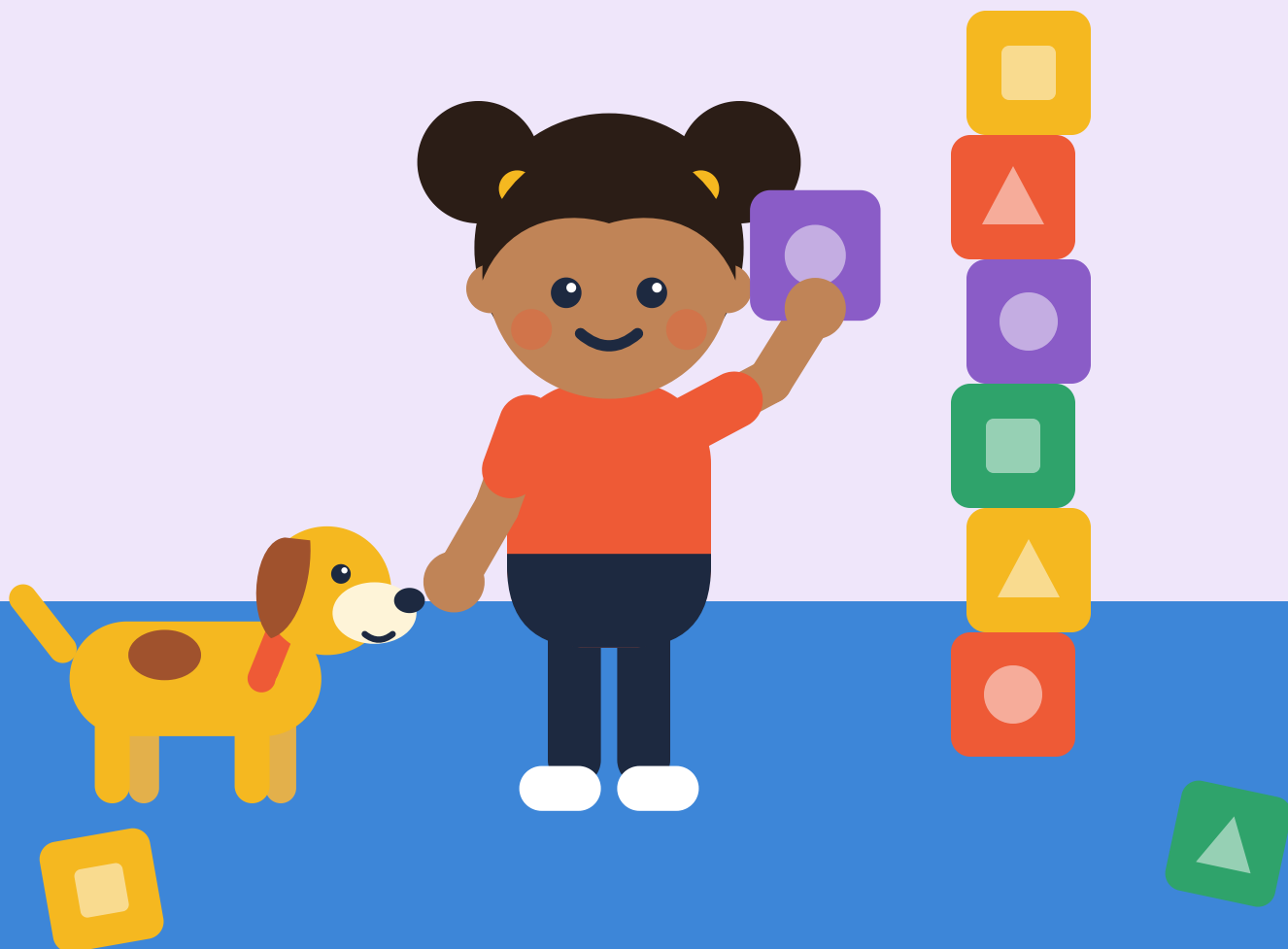


“A nap?” said Ada. “In the MORNING?”
“Even tablets get sleepy,” said Papa.

Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do?



Ada found the blocks.
One, two, three... a tower!
Four, five, six... taller than Biscuit!
Biscuit held very, very still.



Seven... eight... **CRASH!**

Biscuit said, **WOOF!**

Ada said, "AGAIN!"

So they built it again. And again. And AGAIN.



Outside, the rain had left puddles everywhere.
Big ones. Small ones. One with a duck in it!
Ada pulled on her yellow boots.



SPLISH went the small one.

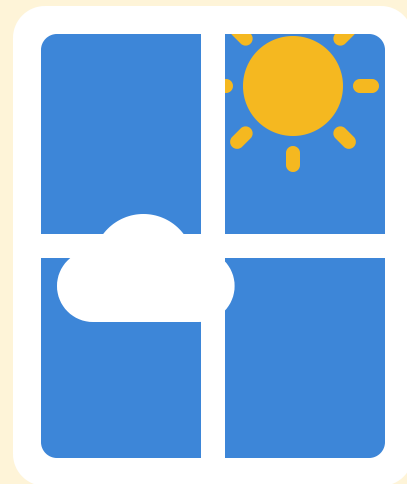
SPLASH went the middle one.

SPLOOOSH went the great big one, all over Papa's shoes!

“Oops,” said Ada. “Oops,” said Papa...
and he jumped in too.



Back inside, Ada peeled off
her wet boots and tiptoed
to the shelf.
Tip... tip... tip...



The tablet was still asleep.
It snored a teeny-tiny snore:
zzz-bip... zzz-bip...

Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do?



In the hall sat a big, empty box.

“That's not a box,” said Ada.

“That's a **ROCKET!**”



She gave it round windows.
She gave it red wings.
She gave it a pointy purple top,
just like the tablet's nightcap.
Biscuit said, **WOOF!** (That means “Me too.”)



“Ten, nine, eight...” counted Ada.
Biscuit held on tight.
“...three, two, ONE!”

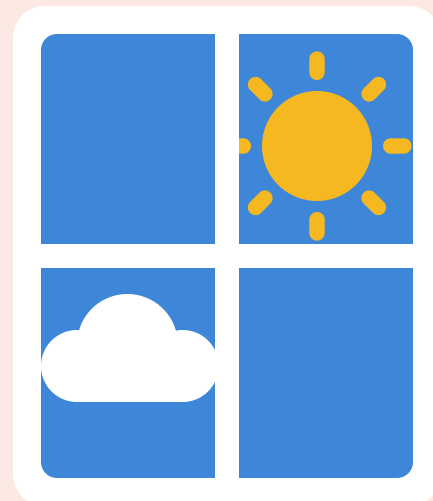
WHOOOOOSH!



Past the moon. Past the stars.
Past a planet made entirely of socks.
Biscuit was the co-pilot.
He was very good at barking at comets.



All that flying made Ada hungry.
Her tummy rumbled like a rocket.
“Pancakes?” asked Papa.
“**PANCAKES!**” said Ada.

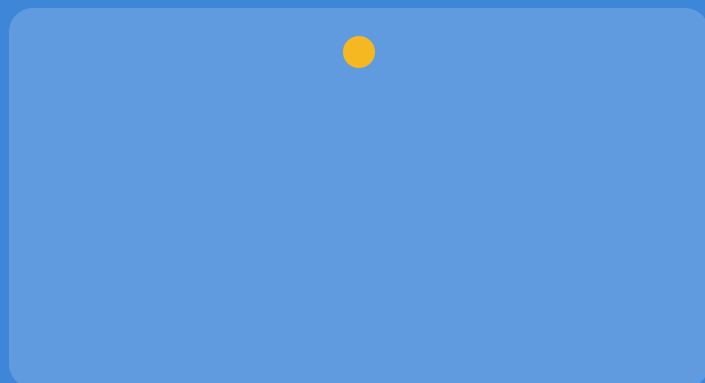
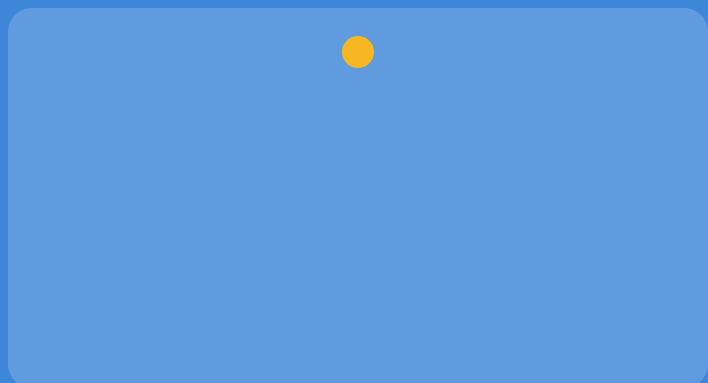


Ada cracked the egg (mostly into the bowl).

She stirred and stirred. Papa flipped.

Flip! Flop! Plop!

“That one looks like the moon,” said Ada.

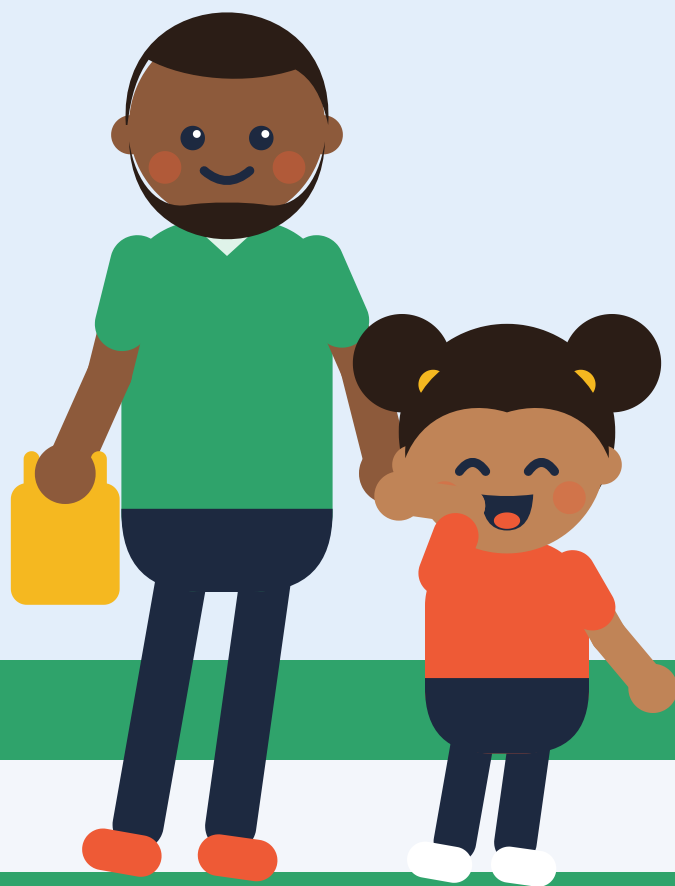


After lunch, Ada peeked at the shelf.
The tablet had rolled over.
Its nightcap had flopped.
But it was still asleep.



Shhh... the tablet is sleeping.
So what shall we do?

“Let's go find some stories,” said Papa.



The library had books about dinosaurs,
books about rockets, books about the moon,
and one book about a dog in boots.

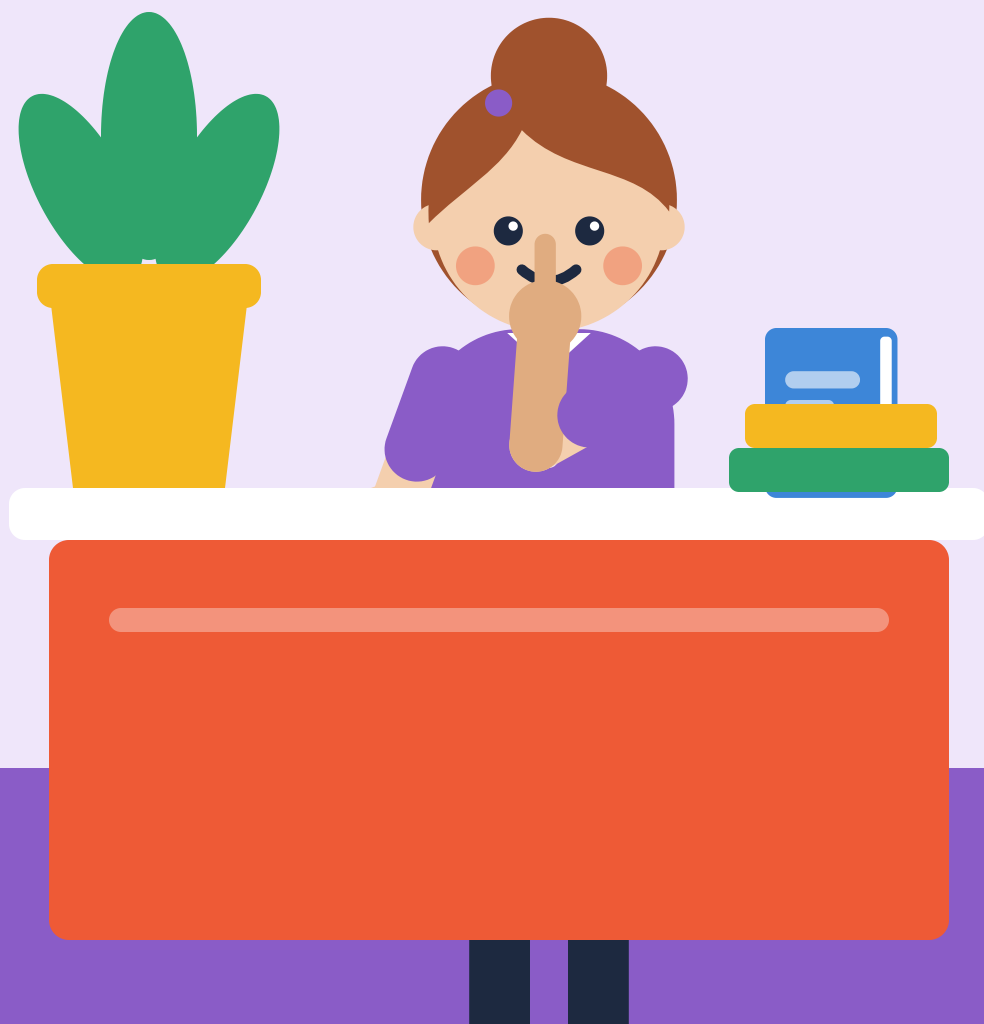


“Shhh,” whispered Ms. Rosa the librarian.

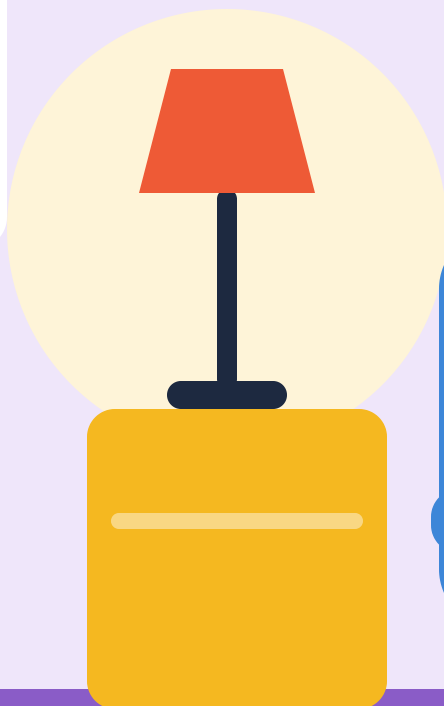
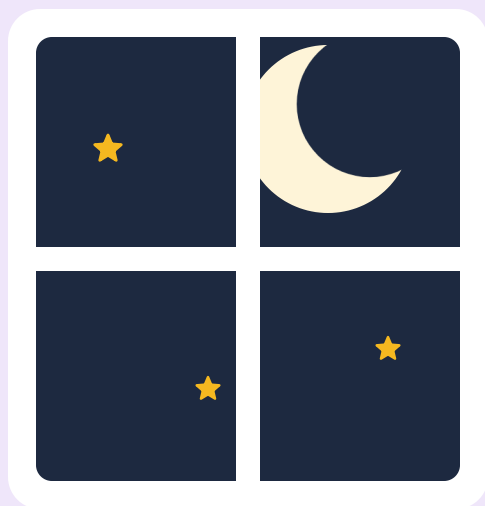
“Books like it quiet.”

“Just like the tablet!” whispered Ada.

She picked a book about a bear
who could not sleep.



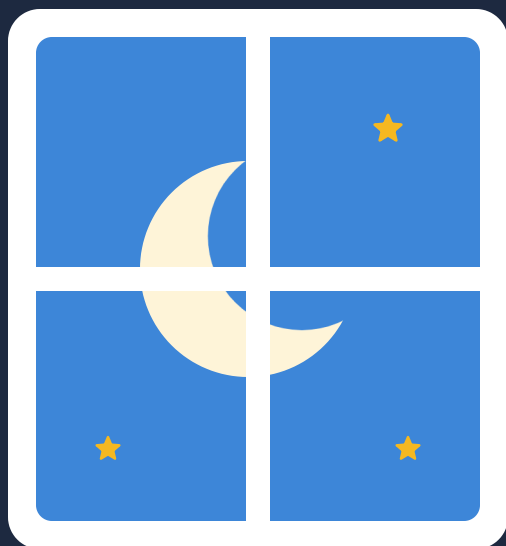
That night, Papa read the bear book.
Ada turned the pages.
She did all the growly bear voices.
GRRR... YAWWWN.



“What was the best part of today?” asked Papa.
Ada thought and thought.
“The crash. The splash. The rocket.
The pancakes. The library...”
She yawned a big bear yawn. “All of it.”



Down the hall, in its cozy nightcap,
the tablet slept on,
dreaming a quiet, happy dream.



And snug in her bed,
with Biscuit at her feet,
Ada slept too.

Shhh... everybody is sleeping.
What a day. What a PLAY day.



In the morning, the tablet woke up and stretched.

“Good morning!” said Ada.

“Wait till I tell you about my day...”

Biscuit said, **WOOF!**



The End

Talk about it

For grown-ups: after reading, try a few of these. Pause, wait, and let your child answer. There are no wrong answers.



1 Why do you think the tablet was so sleepy? When do *you* like to rest?

2 Crash, splash, rocket, pancakes, library... which part would you pick?

3 What could a big box turn into at our house?

4 Say the sleepy part with me: “Shhh...” What does Biscuit say?

5 What should we cook together? What will your job be?

6 Let’s plan our own Play Day. Pick three things to do!

Read it again, and... say what you see (“Biscuit is jumping!”), repeat and add one word (“Splash!” → “Big splash!”), and follow your child’s lead. Let them shout the “Shhh...” and the “WOOF!”

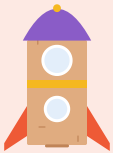


Plan your own Play Day

Draw or write one thing for each part of the day. Then do it together!



Morning



Afternoon



Bedtime story



Free for grown-ups: a printable Play Day planner and coloring pages. Scan the code or visit

playbeforepixels.com/bonus/picture-tablet-slept

Want more ideas? This story pairs with *100 Screen-Free Plays*.

A note from the author

FOUNDER WRITES THIS PAGE

A short note in your own voice (60–120 words): why you wrote this story.

Type it under `## note` in WORDS.md, then rebuild.

Keep it about play, reading and family time. No health claims.



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